

Remote Access and VPN Policy

Version 3.2 · Owner: IT Department · Review: annually

1. Purpose

This policy explains how staff connect to company systems from outside the office. It applies to all employees, contractors and temporary staff who work remotely, including from home, client sites and while travelling.

2. When the VPN is required

The company VPN must be used whenever you access internal systems from any network that is not the office network. This includes home broadband, mobile hotspots, hotel and café Wi-Fi. Internal systems include the intranet, shared drives, the ticketing system and all finance applications.

3. Multi-factor authentication

Every VPN connection requires multi-factor authentication (MFA) using the company authenticator app. Text-message codes are not accepted for VPN access. If you change your phone, raise a ticket to reset your MFA registration before you travel.

4. Session limits

A VPN session stays connected for a maximum of 12 hours. After 12 hours the session is disconnected automatically and you must sign in again with MFA. Sessions that are idle for 60 minutes are also disconnected.

5. VPN certificates

Each laptop holds a VPN certificate that is valid for 365 days. You must renew your certificate from the self-service portal at least 14 days before it expires. An expired certificate prevents the VPN from connecting; renew it from the office network or call the service desk.

6. Personal devices

Personal devices may connect to the VPN only if the company endpoint agent is installed and reporting as healthy. Personal devices may never be used to store Confidential or Restricted data.

7. Travel

If you plan to work from a country on the security team's restricted list, you must notify the security team at least 5 working days before you travel. VPN access from restricted countries is blocked by default.

8. Reporting problems

Report VPN problems to the service desk with your username, location and the exact error message.